- **Ontology in the Semantic Web context** means a **formal representation of knowledge within a specific domain**, which defines concepts, their interrelationships, and rules. It provides a shared understanding of that domain, which allows different systems to communicate and reason about data effectively.
- **Ontology in computer science** is defined as a **model for domain concepts**. More specifically, it can mean:
  - A **knowledge body** of a specific domain that describes concepts and relationships to be used in various applications.
  - The **foundational concepts** in a domain, including their relationships and constraints.
  - The **foundation of building software**, acting as a declarative description of domain concepts and a common reference point between different software units.
- **Ontology in AI Knowledge Engineering** is categorized as **domain knowledge**. It serves as the basic level of knowledge that describes the concepts of a domain. Within this field, it is also defined as a **representation of shared knowledge** that can exist on several levels, such as an informal team level, a professional "jargon" level, or a machine-readable level.
- **Ontology in a formal technical sense** is defined as a **"formal, explicit specification of a shared conceptualization"**. The sources break this definition down as follows:
  - **Formal:** It must be machine-readable.
  - **Explicit:** The types of concepts and the constraints on their use are clearly defined.
  - **Shared:** The captured knowledge is not private to an individual but is accepted by a group.
  - **Conceptualization:** It is an abstract model of a phenomenon in the world created by identifying relevant concepts.
- **Ontology as a Knowledge Body** models the **meaning within a certain domain** and is used to give computers the ability to infer more information. For example, in the medical field, the interrelationships between diseases or symptoms can each be represented as an ontology.